





D·R·A·G·O·N·S

. Monster Week Folio .

When we first came up with *Monster Week* in the spring of 2024, our goal was to build something that brings the tabletop creator community together in a fun, playful way. “Like a real-life beach episode,” we agreed, which is what led us to the ocean theme that ultimately spawned Kraken Week. We weren’t sure if it would get much participation at first, but we hoped it might grow over time.

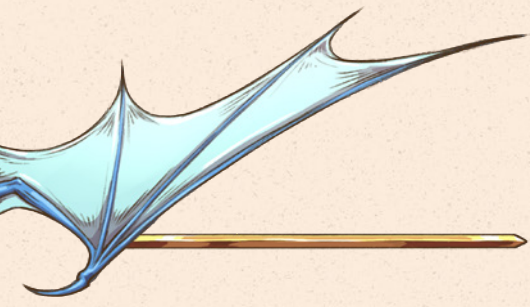
We were absolutely blown away by the enthusiasm for the event in that first year. Creators ended up submitting more than a hundred and sixty videos, including everything from game advice to original music to miniature painting. We quickly realized that if we were going to do this again, we would need a broader theme. Thus Kraken Week became *Monster Week*: an annual community event where creators point their various talents at a different iconic monster each year.

This year’s target is the monster of all monsters, the dragon. In this folio, we wanted to cover dragons across the spectrum, from terrifying monsters to reptilian friends, and everything in between. We hope this helps you bring dragons to your own game tables in exciting new ways.

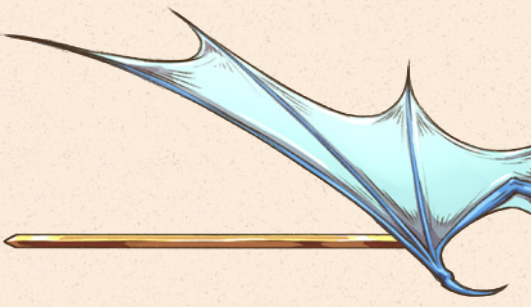
Monster Week wouldn’t work without all the creators and viewers who decided to jump into the kraken-infested waters with us in 2024, and venture into the dragon’s lair with us in 2025. This folio is dedicated to every single person who has joined us in getting fired up about Dragon Week — including you!

GINNY DI & Pointy Hat





Credits



WRITING AND GAME DESIGN

Ginny Di and Pointy Hat (Antonio Demico)

LINE EDITING

Briar Banerji

ART DIRECTION

Antonio Demico

EDITING

Matt Best

COVER ART

Squidrz

PROOFREADING

Marcie Wood

ILLUSTRATION

Pilar Hernández, Runa Solaris

LAYOUT

Morgan Dunbar

ADDITIONAL ART

Antonio Demico



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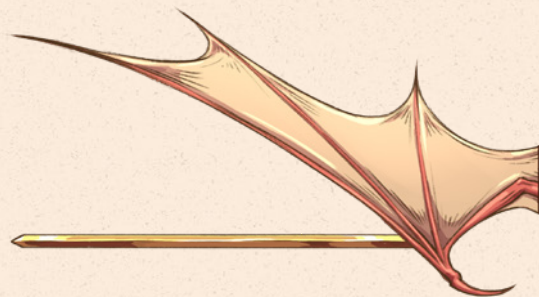
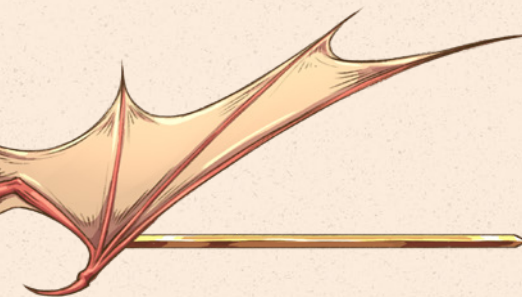
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• Part 1: For Players •





Drake

A Playable Dragon Species

Warden dragons do not reproduce. There is a set number of warden dragons in any given world. For any other species this would spell certain doom, as they would die off without the capability to create new life, but this isn't the case for warden dragons, because their draconic essence never truly dies.

When a warden dragon is ready to pass on, it selects a member of the hoard it has amassed during its long lifespan and prepares them to receive its essence. This member of the hoard is often referred to as a prince, as they are poised to inherit a great gift. The prince trains to receive this essence, and, when they are ready, the ritual of draconic anointment begins.

A successful ritual ensures the transference of the draconic essence into the body of the prince, transforming said body into that of a juvenile dragon. The prince's previous self is not erased in the process, but changed irrevocably; they might have a hazy understanding of their previous life, or no recollection at all, but the prince's personality remains the same, even if the body has changed completely.

Should a warden dragon fail to pass on its essence and die, that essence disperses itself in the aether and takes centuries, even millennia, to reform into a body of its own. Warden dragons fear death the most of all dragons, as they know that even though their essence will always come back, it might take an impossibly long time to do so.

But this is also true of the prince-turned-dragon, for they are never more at risk than at this stage. This is why the new dragon quickly finds a hoard of its own: an adventuring party. These dragon princes often join a party and establish it as their first hoard, learn from the members of this party, and, in time, develop into the warden dragon they will eventually become. This is how warden dragons gain their expertise in wizardry, or sorcery, or the martial techniques of a paladin or a rogue: by learning from their party, the hoard they form as they travel during their infancy and grow into a true warden dragon.

A NOTE ON PLAYING A DRAKE:

The drake species has been designed to be played as the prince of a warden dragon, but also as any of the existing dragons in Fifth Edition. If you wish to play not a warden dragon but a copper, black, or other dragon, your drake could be a young member of that species, going out into the world for the first time, or an elder dragon cursed into the body of a juvenile seeking to remove this curse. Nothing about the traits of this species forces you to play a warden dragon.

Drake Traits

Creature Type: Dragon

Size: Medium (about 3-5 feet tall at the withers, about 5-6 feet tall when standing on hind legs)

Speed: 30 feet

As a Drake, you have these special traits.

Draconic Essence. Your draconic essence determines what kind of dragon you are. Choose a kind of dragon from the Draconic Kind table. Your choice affects your Breath Weapon and Draconic Resistance traits as well as your appearance.





Draconic Kind

CHROMATIC DRAGON	DAMAGE TYPE
Black	Acid
Blue	Lightning
Green	Poison
Red	Fire
White	Cold

METALLIC DRAGON	DAMAGE TYPE
Brass	Fire
Bronze	Lightning
Copper	Acid
Gold	Fire
Silver	Cold

WARDEN DRAGON	DAMAGE TYPE
Archon	Fire
Knight	Slashing
Magus	Psychic
Patron	Force
Rooker	Poison

Breath Weapon. When you take the Attack action on your turn, you can replace one of your attacks with an exhalation of magical energy in either a 15-foot Cone or a 30-foot Line that is 5 feet wide (choose the shape each time). Each creature in that area must make a Dexterity saving throw (DC 8 plus your Constitution modifier and Proficiency Bonus). On a failed save, a creature takes 1d10 damage of the type determined by your Draconic Essence trait. On a successful save, a creature takes half as much damage. This damage increases by 1d10 when you reach character levels 5 (2d10), 11 (3d10), and 17 (4d10).

You can use this Breath Weapon a number of times equal to your Proficiency Bonus, and you regain all expended uses when you finish a Long Rest.

Darkvision. You have Darkvision with a range of 120 feet.

Drake Jaws. Your draconic jaws can be used to hold weapons just as dexterously as a Humanoid's hands. You can use your mouth to interact with objects, perform Somatic components, and hold weapons. When you do so, you ignore a weapon's Two-Handed property, and you can perform Somatic and Verbal components even while holding a weapon in your mouth, but you are unable to dual wield.

Drake Resistance. You have Resistance to the damage type associated with your Draconic Kind.

Drake Scales. You have a base Armor Class of 17 (your Dexterity modifier doesn't affect this number). You can't wear Light, Medium, or Heavy Armor and you cannot don Shields.

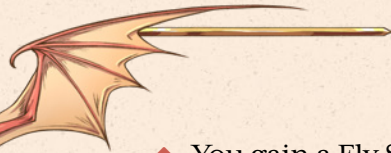
Drake Shift. When you reach character level 5, you can transform as a Bonus Action using one of the options below (choose the option each time you transform). Once you transform, you can't do so again until you finish a Long Rest. Here are the transformation options:

TRUE DRAGON:

You unleash your full draconic essence to reach your true draconic form. You gain the following benefits:

- ◆ Your size increases from Medium to Large.





- ◆ You gain a Fly Speed equal to your Speed.
- ◆ You gain additional uses of your Breath Weapon equal to half of your proficiency bonus rounded down. These additional uses can go over the total uses of your Breath Weapon, but they are lost the moment your transformation ends. For example, if you transform into a True Dragon at level 5 while not having spent any uses of your Breath Weapon, you now have 4 uses of your breath weapon. If you end your transformation without spending any of these uses, you would have 3 uses, having lost the extra use given by acquiring this form.

The transformation lasts for 1 minute or until you end it (no action required).

FALSE PERSON:

You assume the form of a Humanoid to blend in better with non-dragons. Your Humanoid form does not affect your Hit Points or ability scores, and you do not gain any traits associated with the species of Humanoid you choose to turn into. While in this form, you lose your Drake Jaws, Drake Resistance, and Drake Scales traits, but you gain the ability to don any armor and Shields that your class grants you, and you are able to dual-wield weapons. Each time you choose this transformation option, you transform into the same Humanoid; you decide the species and appearance of this Humanoid the first time you choose this transformation option. The transformation lasts for 8 hours or until you end it (no action required).



Variant Pseudodragons

Draconic Companions

Just as the archetypal dragon of legend is a red fire-breather, the most commonly known pseudodragon is a uniform, muddy red color. But like their full-sized dragon kin, pseudodragons exist in many forms, some quite rare. These variant pseudodragons might be found as solitary specimens in remote areas, coexisting with true dragons of their same

type, or even in the sanctums of arcane biologists whose experiments focus on the breeding and/or creation of magical creatures.

Anywhere a pseudodragon may appear, such as in the role of a Pact of the Chain Warlock's familiar, one of these variant pseudodragons can take its place.





Chromatic Pseudodragon

Chromatic pseudodragons have scales in various hues that match their true-dragon kin: flashy, tropical green; rich, jewel-toned red or blue; or even a stark black or white. But unlike their true-dragon ancestors, pseudodragon scales may display elaborate patterns — like stripes, spots, or scale tips — in complementary or contrasting colors. Still, each chromatic pseudodragon has a clear main color corresponding to their chromatic lineage. A leaf green pseudodragon with a bright, acid yellow belly shares the same genetic traits as a forest green pseudodragon with subtle brown stripes. Their chromatic lineage likewise determines what effect their tail stinger has, as well as what damage types they are resistant to. Though a white pseudodragon is not capable of delivering the devastating cold breath that a full-sized white dragon can, it is just as comfortable in extreme cold, and potentially as dangerous to those unwary of its cryotoxic sting.

While all pseudodragons have a social, playful nature, those related to chromatic dragons have a villainous streak reminiscent of their notoriously evil progenitors. Chromatic dragons' greediness may manifest in their pseudodragon kin as a ravenous hunger and defensiveness around food, a fixation on hoarding shiny objects, or a fierce, protective jealousy over a mate or bonded humanoid. When tested, these pseudodragons display a spitefulness that could put even the most tyrannical house-cat to shame. If your black pseudodragon hasn't had the pleasure of a swim in a week or two, you might catch her

knocking potion bottles off a shelf or relieving herself onto your bedroll in an effort to show her irritation.

Chromatic pseudodragons typically hunt small prey, such as insects, songbirds, fish, or rodents. Not only are they obligate carnivores, the act of hunting is important for their enrichment and mental stimulation. A chromatic pseudodragon fed on dried meats, prepared food, or even captive prey tends to grow restless and irritable over time.

CHROMATIC PSEUDODRAGON

Tiny Dragon, Chaotic Good

AC 14 **Initiative** +2 (12)

HP 10 (3d4 + 3)

Speed 15 ft., fly 60 ft.

	MOD		SAVE			MOD		SAVE			MOD		SAVE	
STR	6	-2	-2		DEX	14	+2	+2		CON	12	+1	+1	
INT	9	-1	-1		WIS	12	+1	+1		CHA	12	+1	+1	

Skills Perception +5, Stealth +4

Senses Blindsight 10 ft., Darkvision 60 ft.; passive Perception 15

Languages Understands Common and Draconic but can't speak

CR 1/4 (XP 50; PB +2)

TRAITS

Chromatic Resistance. The chromatic pseudodragon has resistance to a damage type based on its color: acid (black), cold (white), fire (red), lightning (blue), or poison (green).

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The chromatic pseudodragon makes two Bite attacks.

Bite. Melee Attack Roll: +4, reach 5 ft. Hit: 4 (1d4 + 2) Piercing damage.





Chromatic Sting. Constitution Saving Throw:

DC 12, one creature the pseudodragon can see within 5 feet. Failure: 5 (2d4) damage plus an additional effect. The damage type and effect are determined by the pseudodragon's color:

- **Black (Acid).** The target's AC is reduced by 1 until the end of its next turn as corrosive venom eats at its defenses.
- **Blue (Lightning).** The target can't take reactions until the start of its next turn, jolted by a sudden shock.
- **Green (Poison).** The target has disadvantage on its next attack roll before the end of its next turn, its senses dulled by toxins.
- **Red (Fire).** The target takes 1d4 fire damage at the start of its next turn as lingering embers burn.
- **White (Cold).** The target's speed is halved until the end of its next turn, its limbs stiff with frost.

REACTIONS

Territorial Nip. Trigger: A creature willingly enters the chromatic pseudodragon's reach. Response: The chromatic pseudodragon makes a Bite attack against that creature.

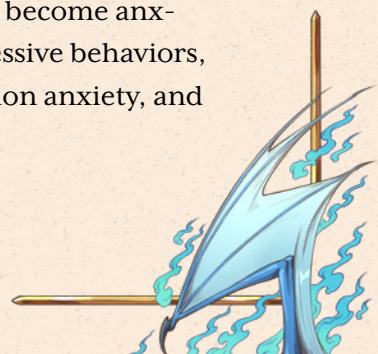


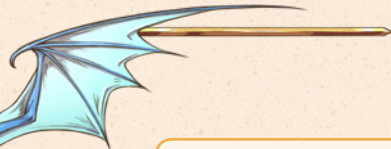
Metallic Pseudodragon

Metallic pseudodragons share the glossy, reflective scales of metallic dragons, appearing in gleaming metal tones like silver, brass, or copper. Most have long, lightweight whiskers that appear to float around their faces, giving these tiny wyrms a slightly wizened countenance. These types of pseudodragon are more likely to sport elaborate frills, spines, and horns than their less ornate chromatic relatives, and have a tendency towards longer, thinner body types. However, even the eldest of them lack the noble patina that colors the oldest true metallics.

They have neither breath weapons like their larger ancestors, nor a stinger at the end of their tails like their chromatic cousins. Instead the unique abilities provided by a metallic pseudodragon's lineage appear when they shapeshift. Just as metallic dragons can take on a humanoid form, their pseudodragon descendants have developed a similar skill. They can take on the form of a tiny beast, even gaining the ability to communicate with other beasts while in this shape.

Metallic pseudodragons are curious and eager to please, making them an ideal familiar choice for a spellcaster who wants a responsive and well-trained companion. They thrive on routine and do best when given regular opportunities to learn, whether that be a strict combat regimen, a language of hand gesture commands, or even playful exploration of acrobatic and magical tricks. Without clear structure and consistency, metallic pseudodragons have a tendency to become anxious, which may result in obsessive behaviors, destructive hoarding, separation anxiety, and decreased appetite.





METALLIC PSEUDODRAGON

Tiny Dragon, Chaotic Good

AC 14 **Initiative** +2 (12)

HP 10 (3d4 + 3)

Speed 15 ft., fly 60 ft.

MOD SAVE			MOD SAVE			MOD SAVE		
STR	6	-2 -2	DEX	15	+2 +2	CON	12	+1 +1
INT	9	-1 -1	WIS	14	+2 +2	CHA	10	+0 +0

Skills Perception +5, Stealth +4

Senses Blindsight 10 ft., Darkvision 60 ft.;
passive Perception 16

Languages Understands Common and Draconic but
can't speak

CR 1/4 (XP 50; PB +2)

TRAITS

Magic Resistance. The metallic pseudodragon has Advantage on saving throws against spells and other magical effects.

Reflective Scales. When a ranged attack targets the metallic pseudodragon, roll a d6. On a 6, the attack automatically misses as the metallic scales reflect dazzling light at the attacker.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The metallic pseudodragon makes two Bite attacks.

Bite. *Melee Attack Roll:* +4, reach 5 ft. Hit: 4 (1d4 + 2) Piercing damage.

BONUS ACTIONS

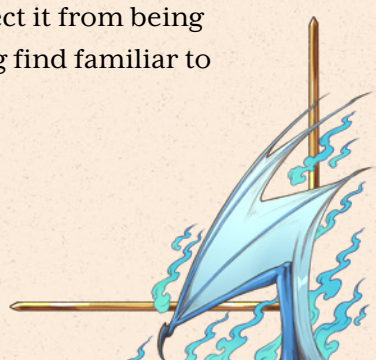
Shapechange. The metallic pseudodragon magically shape-shifts into a Tiny beast, or it returns to its true form. Its game statistics are the same in each form, except that it can communicate with other beasts while in the form of a beast.

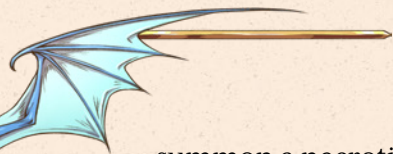
Necrotic Pseudodragon

A necrotic pseudodragon could never be mistaken for a living pseudodragon. Between the bleached white bone peeking out from under decomposing flesh, the profane purple magic that sustains its unholy animation, and the noxious smell, this creature is obviously undead to anyone who observes it.

Those who utilize these rotting, reincarnated creatures as familiars or messengers value function over form, ignoring their haunting aesthetic to enjoy the benefits of undeath. Necrotic pseudodragons have none of the inconvenient needs that a living creature has, such as food, water, or sleep. While a living pseudodragon may have behavioral issues or social needs, a necrotic pseudodragon has only a rudimentary intelligence and performs its commands without emotion and with no need for training. No matter how many times it is killed and reanimated, it will never grow resentful or fearful. This makes it ideal amongst spellcasters who seek a familiar as a tool rather than a companion.

When this type of creature is created, a necromancer begins with the corpse of a pseudodragon. Any type will do, since none of its chromatic or metallic abilities are accessible once it has been raised. A single scale, known as a grave scale, is removed from the corpse to act as an anchor for what remains of its life force. Once the ritual is complete and the necrotic pseudodragon is animate, the creator or owner keeps the grave scale with them, typically in a small glass vial or integrated into a piece of jewelry to protect it from being damaged or lost. When casting find familiar to





summon a necrotic pseudodragon, the grave scale replaces the spell's material components (without being consumed).

While many find necromancy distasteful at best and downright evil at worst, necrotic pseudodragons are generally considered to be a utilitarian and relatively harmless form of necromancy. Those who are not interested in

dabbling in the necromantic arts themselves can commission them to be made, taking possession of the grave scale by way of a bonding ritual after the creature is created. A mage with a necrotic pseudodragon familiar may receive judgemental looks at a party, but is unlikely to be considered wicked or corrupt except by the especially sanctimonious.

NECROTIC PSEUDODRAGON

Tiny Dragon, Neutral

AC 14 **Initiative** +2 (12)

HP 19 (3d4 + 9)

Speed 15 ft., fly 60 ft.

MOD			SAVE			MOD			SAVE			MOD			SAVE								
STR	10	0	0	DEX	15	+2	+2	CON	16	+3	+3	INT	6	-2	-2	WIS	11	+0	+0	CHA	8	-1	-1

Skills Perception +4, Stealth +4

Senses Blindsight 10 ft., Darkvision 60 ft.;

passive Perception 14

Languages Understands Common and Draconic but can't speak

CR 1/4 (XP 50; PB +2)

TRAITS

Grave Scale. The creature that commands the necrotic pseudodragon has a Tiny magical object called a grave scale. The grave scale can be used in place of the material components for the find familiar spell when summoning the necrotic pseudodragon and is not consumed.

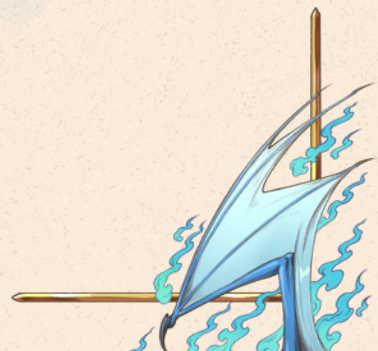
The grave scale has AC 13, 5 Hit Points, immunity to necrotic, poison, and psychic damage, and immunity to all damage so long as it is worn or carried by its owner. It regains all its Hit Points at the end of each hour. If reduced to 0 Hit Points, the grave scale turns to ash and the necrotic pseudodragon is permanently destroyed.

Magic Resistance. The necrotic pseudodragon has Advantage on saving throws against spells and other magical effects.

ACTIONS

Necrotic Bite. *Melee Attack Roll:* +4, reach 5 ft. Hit: 4 (1d4 + 2) Necrotic damage. The necrotic pseudodragon regains hit points equal to the damage dealt.

Rotting Sting. *Constitution Saving Throw:* DC 12, one creature the pseudodragon can see within 5 feet. Failure: 5 (2d4) necrotic damage, and the target can't regain hit points until the end of its next turn.



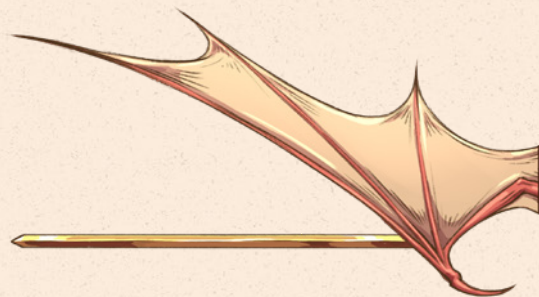
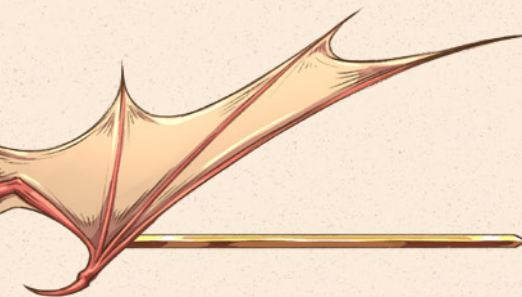
• Part 2: For DMs •





Dragon NPCs

IN THIS SECTION YOU'LL FIND THREE DIFFERENT DRAGON NPCs, WITH DETAILED BACKGROUNDS, ROLEPLAYING TIPS, AND VARIOUS QUEST HOOKS TO ADD THEM TO YOUR GAMES.



Zivryl

The Masked Merchant: *Chaotic good, young copper dragon (he/him)*

Zivrylarenoth is a young copper dragon, though most who meet the cheerful, human-looking merchant called “Zivryl” don’t know that. His preferred humanoid guise is that of a short, broad-shouldered man with a wide smile, slicked-back ginger curls, and a tiny pair of brass pince-nez perched on his nose. He dresses in neat but over-embellished, bright-colored clothing that announces his wealth. His loud, unrestrained laugh and easy charm makes him the life of any party. Zivryl is known for his good humor, his love of fine wine and tragic ballads, and his generous tips at local entertainment establishments. Despite his warm demeanor, those who do business with him quickly learn that behind that cheerful smile is a ruthless and unrelenting businessman.

Zivryl’s Imports operates out of a modest storefront atop a hill, with a large walled courtyard behind it that serves as a discreet landing pad for his draconic form. The advantage of having easy access to high-volume air delivery allows him to transport goods quickly and cheaply, which has made him a wildly successful importer. The shop offers a rotating selection of luxury goods, like woven rugs, rare spices, and fine ceramics, based on whatever Zivryl has most recently flown in.

These items attract casual buyers, but they’re secondary to his true trade: commissioned importing. Wealthy clients and business owners come to him for bulk and bespoke shipments, knowing he can deliver nearly anything they need faster than any ship or caravan — gladly paying nearly twice the price for the privilege.

In dragon form, Zivryl is stocky and muscular. He still wears his pince-nez, but appropriately larger and attached to a chain to prevent them from being lost while he flies. When transporting goods, he hangs a wooden sign labeled “Zivryl’s Imports” off his tail, as he believes this enhances his appearance of professionalism when picking up shipments. He is careful to remove this sign before drawing close to home.

Zivryl finds his human form not only convenient for business, but also more comfortable and more beautiful. He’s deeply self-conscious about his draconic body and reacts to being seen in it much like someone might react to being caught naked. As a result, he only hunts under the cover of night and typically flies great distances to avoid notice. Only a small number of highly trusted confidantes know Zivryl’s true form, and he is very invested in keeping it that way.





Background

Zivryl was first drawn to human settlements by their music, art, and drink, which delighted him. He envied the easy camaraderie he saw between humans and quickly learned that he could share in it by taking on their form. He began importing goods to fund his indulgent tastes and soon discovered that his natural speed and strength gave him an edge over his human competitors.

When he was caught feasting on a local farmer's livestock, he braced for anger, but found only fear. The townsfolk cowered, bowed, and brought him offerings, even when he appeared in human form. Their reverence was isolating and left him feeling hollow, so Zivryl left. He traveled a great distance before starting over, this time vowing to carefully guard his secret.





Roleplaying Zivryl

When roleplaying Zivryl, lean into his charm and theatricality. He's warm and talkative, always ready to flatter, joke, or share a story that may or may not be true. He gestures broadly when he talks, punctuating points with a raised wineglass or an emphatic fist on the table. He loves compliments and hates being alone. The fastest way to get on Zivryl's good side is to laugh at his jokes. He rarely shows anger, and even when his tone betrays tension, the smile never leaves his face.

Zivryl keeps his true identity closely guarded. Unless they have truesight or some other magical means to uncover the truth, characters will only see his human form. He will not reveal his true nature unless absolutely necessary. If the characters let on that they know he is a dragon, he treats this as an immediate threat. He needs assurance that they will not share this information, or he does his best to get them out of town permanently.

Trait	"I'm careful with my coin... except when a musician plays something that truly moves me."
Ideal	"Beauty, art, and fellowship are the true treasures of the world. Gold is only precious in that it allows you to attain them."
Bond	"I built a life where people smile when they see me, not scream. I'll do anything to keep it that way."
Flaw	"When I have one too many drinks, I may sing. This is an unpleasant experience for everyone, including me."

Quest Hooks

NEST EGG

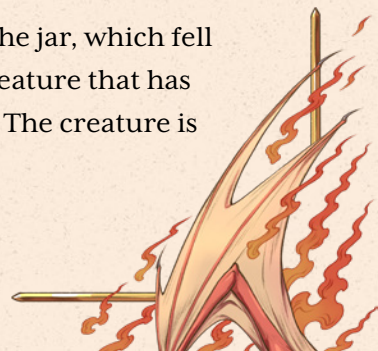
The characters encounter Zivryl at his shop, soaking wet and in an unusually foul mood. He explains that his most recent shipment, which was being delivered by air, was struck by a sudden storm, causing it to drop some of its cargo mid-flight. The most important missing item is a large ceramic jar containing a very valuable dried spice. He has pinpointed the location of the fall to a specific forested ridge, but is unable to retrieve it himself as he's expected at an exclusive party; his absence would not only be noticed, but damaging. As a reward for the jar's safe recovery, he offers gold pieces or store credit at Zivryl's Imports:

- ◆ Levels 1-2: 100 gp (125 gp credit)
- ◆ Levels 3-5: 400 gp (500 gp credit)
- ◆ Levels 6-9: 900 gp (1,125 gp credit)
- ◆ Levels 10+: 2,500 gp (3,125 gp credit)

The drop site is a steep hillside choked with broken tree limbs from the violence of the storm. The party's search is impeded by difficult terrain, and they may encounter other concerns along the way, such as (choose or determine randomly):

- ◆ a wounded animal trapped beneath a fallen tree
- ◆ a landslide triggered by the characters' exploration
- ◆ a **dryad** weeping beside a tree split by lightning

Eventually, characters locate the jar, which fell into the nest of a territorial creature that has mistaken it for one of its eggs. The creature is





protective and becomes hostile if it notices any creature trying to get close to its nest.

The creature might be:

- ◆ a mated pair of **giant eagles** (level 1-2)
- ◆ a mated pair of **owlbears** (level 3-5)
- ◆ a **tyrannosaurus rex** (level 6-9)
- ◆ a **roc** (level 10-13)

MINOR KEYS ONLY

Zivryl is deeply concerned. His favorite bard, Neira, has begun writing cheerful songs. Once known for her haunting laments and tragic ballads, she now performs pleasant, upbeat tunes that leave audiences smiling and even dancing! Zivryl insists this shift is a disaster for the local music scene and hires the party to investigate. Their task is to discreetly determine what has lifted Neira's spirits, and, if possible, subvert it to bring back the melancholy that made her work so moving. Zivryl emphasizes that no harm should come to her; just enough misfortune to rekindle her melancholic muse.

Neira is not the sort to talk about her personal life with strangers. To learn what's improving her mood, characters will need to get the guarded bard to trust them enough to open up. Once she feels comfortable with the characters, she reveals the reason she's been feeling happier lately (choose or determine randomly):

- ◆ A local baker has begun courting her, leaving warm bread and sweet notes at her door each morning
- ◆ A local noble has hired her to perform for an upcoming private event, an opportunity that will pay well and could facilitate useful connections

- ◆ Her noisy upstairs neighbor finally moved out, allowing her to get restful sleep for the first time in years

Zivryl offers store credit in exchange for their subtle sabotage. But if characters push back on his request, he grows defensive and increases his prices for the party.

Suggested Level: Any

RETURN TO SENDER

Zivryl asks to speak to the characters privately. If they do not already know he is a dragon, he hesitantly reveals the truth, but only after demanding they swear their most sacred vow that they will never betray his trust. He shows them an anonymous letter that was slipped under his door that morning. The writer claims to have witnessed a dragon taking off from Zivryl's courtyard in the dead of night. They're convinced Zivryl is in league with the creature and demand to know the location of the dragon's hoard, otherwise they will tell everyone that the merchant is rubbing elbows with a monster capable of destroying the town. The letter includes a single sending stone and the instructions, "Tell the stone where the hoard lies, and you'll never hear from me again." The deadline is midnight in two days' time.

Zivryl insists he has no hoard ("Just tasteful investments!") but knows the accusation could expose the truth about his identity. He offers 3,000 gp or twice as much in store credit at Zivryl's Imports if the characters can track down the blackmailer and end this threat by whatever means necessary.





Examining the note provides a clue (choose or determine randomly):

- ◆ There is a light imprint of a second letter, written on top of this page, which hints at the writer's identity: a rival merchant who is losing business to Zivryl. In their desperation and paranoia, they've hired a local gang (4 toughs and a tough boss) to prepare for whatever might happen should they need to follow through on their threat. Chasing off their hired muscle will cause the merchant to cave.
- ◆ There is a splatter of red wax on the corner: the same wax used for a certain noble house's seal. Looking into them reveals the local lord is drowning in debt to a mage whose magic has helped grease the wheels for both the lord's finances and marriage pursuits. Eliminating the debt would end the blackmail, but it's also possible to deliver a counter-threat in revealing the truth behind the lord's courtship. They won't back down to "hearsay", so the party will need to acquire the evidence hidden in the lord's secret vault.
- ◆ The paper carries the scent of ash and camphor, which characters recognize from a local apothecary with a loyal customer: a sickly bard who is jealous of the lavish tips Zivryl has been giving other musicians. The bard is willing to forget they saw anything if the party can help them find success. Accomplishing this should require no less than 4 successful DC 15 ability checks, and if the group accrues 3 failures first, then the bard is set in their jealousy. Some possible ways to help are...

- ◆ Persuasion or Insight to appeal to the bard's sense of decency. Failure means they either have none, are too scorned to see reason, or have a very good reason to have animosity against dragons.
- ◆ Performance or Charisma checks with instrument proficiency to aid in a new performance, drawing fresh eyes and ears to the bard.
- ◆ Deception to sow counter-rumors against the bard, making it riskier for them to follow through on their threat.
- ◆ Intimidation to get the bard to back down. "Do you really want to upset a dragon?"
- ◆ Medicine to create a wellness regimen that can help the bard get back on their feet.

Suggested Level: 5-7



Corroxinor

The Blightborn Hatchling: *Neutral, black dragon wyrmling (it/its)*

Corroxinor is a runt, smaller than the average wyrmling and significantly less intelligent. It is approximately the size of a pony, but its jet-black scaled body is rangy and awkward. Its wings are oversized when compared to the rest of it, leaving it stuck in a stage of gawling adolescence as it grows into its body. It has a habit of panting, tongue lolling out of its mouth and dripping noxious green saliva. A lingering scent of rot follows Corroxinor wherever it goes, no matter how recently it's been washed, and its scales have a natural oily sheen

that is somewhat slimy to the touch. It wears a leather collar with a stone disc dangling from it. The symbol of the Circle of Sapwood, a riven tree weeping tears of sap, is etched into the disc's surface.





The wyrmling was raised by the druids of the Circle of Sapwood and has developed a fondness for them, which prevents it from treating humanoids with immediate hostility. Its favorite pastime is delicately removing a fish from water unharmed, and then holding it in place as it suffocates. The druids are trying to break it of this habit. Corroxinor wants to please its caretakers, and enjoys being bathed and receiving little treats as a reward for good behavior. However, it remains extremely dangerous should it choose to become violent. If it grows visibly irritated or upset, the druids become nervous and do whatever they can to settle or distract the wyrmling.

The druids know that black dragons, once matured, sculpt the land around them into fetid, harsh swampland. However, Corroxinor is the direct descendant of an exceptionally malignant bloodline. His mother's presence transformed the area around her lair into a poisoned, toxic wasteland capable of supporting no life but her own. The druids fear Corroxinor shares this amplified draconic influence. This has led to tension in the circle's ranks regarding the ultimate fate of their draconic charge. Some believe the druids should simply kill Corroxinor while it's still small, while others believe they can shepherd the wyrmling into taming its draconic powers and prevent this ecological shift.

Background

Corroxinor was born of a terrible black dragon known as Vythiraxis the Acrid, who built her lair in a half-sunken temple of a now defunct god; the desecrated remains of a faith she took great pleasure in destroying. As her power

grew, so did the blight surrounding her home, which eventually threatened to swallow nearby settlements. To prevent disaster, a band of valiant heroes hunted her down and slew her. In destroying the lair, they also crushed a clutch of eggs they found nestled beneath layers of slime and rot — but missed one. Smaller than the rest and tucked behind a shattered column, Corroxinor's egg was overlooked in the chaos.

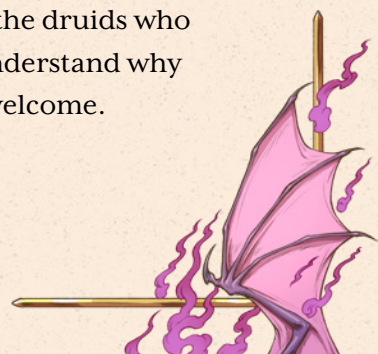
Days later, druids from the Circle of Sapwood arrived to survey the damage Vythiraxis had done to the land and found the lone surviving egg. Despite their concerns, none could bring themselves to destroy a living thing not yet born. Thus the druids found themselves accidental caretakers for the little hatchling.

Roleplaying Corroxinor

Corroxinor should be portrayed as more animalistic than a typical dragon. The combination of its youth, its low intelligence, and the unusual context in which it has been raised results in a creature that largely follows its instincts.

Only those who can speak Draconic can converse with Corroxinor, although it doesn't enjoy conversation and so rarely initiates it. When it does speak, it tends to deliver short answers to any questions with few of its own in return. While its intelligence is lower than is typical for its kind, Corroxinor's limited speech is more a product of its disinterest than its capability.

Corroxinor is eager to please the druids who care for it, but doesn't fully understand why its behavior is sometimes unwelcome.





If frightened or agitated, it becomes volatile and must be soothed quickly. Corroxinor is not particularly malicious, but it *is* dangerous.

Trait	"If I find something interesting, I put it into my mouth."
Ideal	"I like life best when I'm in control. I get the things I want, and don't have to face things that make me feel angry or scared."
Bond	"The druids have always been kind to me. I do my best to make them happy."
Flaw	"When I get upset, I lose control. I don't mean to hurt anyone... but I might."

Quest Hooks

WYRM WATCHERS

The druids seek the characters' help, explaining that word has somehow spread beyond the grove about Corroxinor's existence. A band of dragon hunters (six **warrior infantry**) is en route, led by a well-known **knight** called Eshan Tal, famous for slaying exotic creatures and displaying their skulls as trophies. The druids plead with the characters to intercept the group before they reach the grove and convince them to turn back peacefully. If that fails, they are to delay or mislead the hunters to buy time while the druids temporarily relocate Corroxinor.

As the characters make their way to the dragon hunters' camp, a new problem emerges: Corroxinor has followed them, unsupervised in the chaos. It lurks in the treeline, watching the adventurers with curiosity. If characters send it home, they risk the wyrmling being spotted or captured on the way, but if they accompany it back, there will be no time to hide it before the hunters arrive.

Once the characters reach the hunters' camp, further complications arise (choose or determine randomly):

- ◆ One of the hunting party is an NPC that the characters have an unfriendly relationship with.
- ◆ The hunters have already captured one of the druids and forced them to talk, revealing details about the grove and Corroxinor.
- ◆ The hunters were tipped off by someone within the druid circle who wants Corroxinor dead. Even if the hunters are dealt with, the traitor will continue to cause problems if they aren't identified.

Suggested Level: 4-6

BOOK RECOMMENDATION

The druids call on the characters with good but urgent news: a druidic text thought long lost has resurfaced. Within it are powerful rituals capable of reshaping the land on a fundamental level, including one that they believe could shield the region from the corrupting influence of Vythiraxis' bloodline. If the ritual works, Corroxinor could live freely in the area without fear of poisoning it over time.

But not everyone is glad of the text's reappearance. Another druid circle has caught wind of the discovery and denounces it as unnatural. They believe the rituals in the book are perversions of a druid's sacred duty to protect the land, not alter it to suit their own needs. This circle is already moving to destroy the text before it can be recovered.





The characters must locate the text before the opposing circle does. It is hidden in a dangerous, forgotten place (choose or determine randomly):

- ◆ a collapsed mycelial research enclave now overrun with toxic spores and fungal beasts
- ◆ a buried sandstone tower slowly emerging from the dunes where it has been hidden for millenia
- ◆ a ridge of mountains whose extensive network of tunnels were created by an extinct sect of druids who sought to reshape the land from the inside out

Along the way, the characters may face agents of the rival circle, such as stealthy saboteurs, summoned beasts, or hostile druids themselves. There's also every chance that druids within the Circle of Sapwood will act against the mission, further complicating the text's retrieval. With knowledge of the mission, they could lay a trap for the party after they have recovered the text and are at their weakest.

Suggested Level: Any

DRAGON DREAMS

Lately, Corroxinor has been having nightmares. Each night it thrashes in its sleep, spewing noxious gas and acid that damages the grove and the druids who live there. When it wakes, Corroxinor remembers nothing but a lingering feeling of fear.

The druid grove has a dream specialist, but the complexity of the draconic mind is beyond her reach with divination spells. So she offers an alternative: she can transport people into

Corroxinor's dream directly, allowing them to witness what it sees and try to soothe the fear from within. But the risk is great, because any who die in another creature's dreams die in the waking world as well. The druids beg the party to undertake the journey, trusting that their experience and strength will keep them safe.

Within the dream, the characters discover what is haunting Corroxinor (choose or determine randomly):

- ◆ Its mother, Vythiraxis the Acrid, disappointed and furious at how weak and pathetic her child has become.
- ◆ The adventurers who killed Vythiraxis and her brood, stomping on fragile eggs and coming for Corroxinor next.
- ◆ The druids, standing in a circle around the wyrmling and whispering amongst themselves about whether to kill it.

The characters must navigate this dreamscape and help Corroxinor confront its fear. If they fail, Corroxinor may awaken panicked and volatile, turning on the druids. If they aren't careful in their dreamwalk, Corroxinor might even turn on the characters within its own dream.

Suggested Level: Any



Pythiarmai

The Silver Sage: *Lawful good, ancient silver dragon (she/her)*

High atop Mount Egeiro, a pristine palace of white stone stands firm against the strong alpine winds and weather. Within its quiet halls slumbers Pythiarmai, the Silver Sage, an ancient silver dragon revered for her gift of prophecy. Her name is spoken with reverence in religious and arcane circles the world over, drawing eclectic communities of would-be parishioners to the slopes of Mount Egeiro. Shrines and sanctuaries dot the long path that winds up from the base, where

pilgrims often leave offerings in hopes of earning a glimpse of their future. Few ever reach the palace, and fewer still are granted entrance.

Pythiarmai is over a thousand years old and shows the weight of her years. Her silver scales are streaked with the black patina of age beneath her gleaming gold and silver jewelry. Her eyes, clouded white with age and the lingering effects of prophecy, do not diminish her commanding presence. Though her mind is sharp, her attention is distant. She is detached from the lives of mortals,





her sense of time stretched so thin that most concerns seem fleeting and small. She resents being pulled from her dreams without cause, rarely speaking with visitors directly so she might prolong her time in prophetic sleep. It is through dreaming that she glimpses what is to come, and her attendants (**priest acolytes**) guard this slumber carefully. Waking her is not a decision made lightly.

Managing access to the Silver Sage is her clerk, Alekos (**priest**), an elderly drow who has served the dragon for centuries. Humorless and precise, Alekos alone determines who may bring a question to the Sage, and what task they must complete before being granted an audience. While his tone is perpetually measured and polite, he has no tolerance for frivolous petitions or self-important visitors. In addition to safeguarding Pythiarmai's sleep, he acts as supervisor for the half dozen attendants that keep the palace clean, secure, and in good repair. When other duties do not demand his attention, Alekos delights in the study and reconstruction of ancient, or even dead, languages.

Background

There are few alive who remember Pythiarmai's youth. Even she struggles to recall it clearly. Centuries of prophecy have layered over her memories, burying them beneath the weight of the countless lives, deaths, and destinies she has witnessed in her dreams.

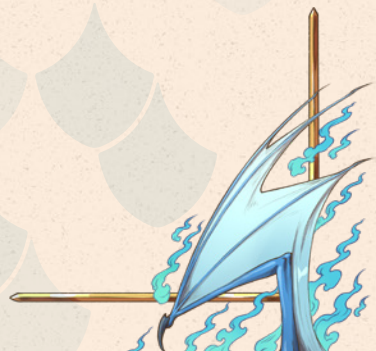
She remembers that her gift of prophecy began early. As a wyrmling, the dreams came in flashes and fragments, often confusing and frightening. At first she believed it was her

duty to change what she saw. For decades she resisted sleep, fearful of what responsibilities she worried came with it, until she dreamt of her own future. She has never told anyone what she saw, but whatever it was settled her mind on a new path. Ever since she has shared her dreams with mortals as best she can, offering guidance to worthy seekers.

Roleplaying Pythiarmai

Pythiarmai speaks slowly and deliberately with an air of calm certainty. She often falls silent for long, uncomfortable stretches — perhaps lost in thought, searching her vast memory, or simply unbothered by the passage of time. Some find this seemingly aloof manner frustrating, especially when her statements turn cryptic. The wise recognize that these are the limitations of her gift. Pythiarmai always shares the full extent of what she has dreamt, even if those visions are incomplete or unclear.

She is not unkind, but she has little patience for desperation; pleading or panicked behavior may irritate her quickly, at which point her clerk will move to end the audience. Whether this is to protect her dignity or her mood, no one is quite sure. If threatened, Pythiarmai remains entirely unfazed. She commits violence only in self defense.





Trait	"I often confuse memory with foresight, and sometimes I'm unsure which I'm speaking of."
Ideal	"The future is fixed, but knowledge can still teach, heal, or inspire, even in the face of an immovable destiny."
Bond	"I am the keeper of futures not yet lived, and it is my duty to share them with those who truly seek them."
Flaw	"I sometimes speak with cruel honesty, forgetting how fragile mortals can be."

Quest Hooks

MEMORIES OF TOMORROW

While the line between past and present is never simple for Pythiarmai, it has worsened as of late. She has begun to confuse visions of the future with events from her past, recalling people she never met and moments that never happened with the clarity of memory. She becomes irritable when these discrepancies are pointed out, perhaps out of shame or fear that her ability is not what it once was. Until the issue is resolved, she is unable to deliver prophecy.

Alekos has determined the source to be an outside force: a divine presence that has taken root within her mind to obscure her sight. A minor god of vengeance, long dormant, now stirs to strike against a rival. The god fears Pythiarmai's dreams may reveal his plan before it can unfold, and so dispatched a fragment of himself into her sleeping mind to cloud her visions. Alekos believes he and the palace attendants can draw this presence out and force it to manifest physically in the dreaming chamber.

Once drawn out of Pythiarmai's mind, this fragment of a god manifests in the dream chamber in the form of a celestial made evil. It may take the form of:

- ◆ a **deva** (2014) — level 5-7; add +2 to all of the deva's d20 tests and save DCs for levels 8-9
- ◆ a **planetar** (2014) — level 10-12; add +1 to all of the planetar's d20 tests and save DCs for levels 13-14
- ◆ a **solar** (2014) — level 15-17

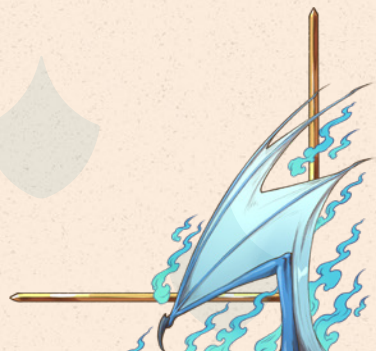
The characters must defeat the celestial in combat to free the Silver Sage's mind. Should they succeed, Alekos grants the party a rare reward: a private audience with the Silver Sage, during which they may ask a single question.

Suggested Level: 5-17

THE DOOR UNSEALED

Pythiarmai dreams of a sealed ruin cracking open to release something that should never wake. A young, ambitious wizard seeks ancient knowledge, unaware that opening this door will unleash an imprisoned horror capable of untold devastation. In the Silver Sage's vision, she saw the characters present, so she knows they must go. She warns them that the seal will break no matter what they do, but hopes they can still do something to reduce the harm that may come of it.

The once-forgotten ruin is difficult to reach, as one would expect for the vault of that which should never be released (choose or determine randomly):





- ◆ high in the Spine Cradle, a narrow mountain ravine filled with jagged rock spires where frequent sleet storms send piercing rockslides to crush freezing trespassers.
- ◆ beneath the Sideways-Tarn, a half-flooded cave system accessible only by diving into an alpine lake charged with illusion magic. Remains litter the floor; all that is left of those drowned by water and fear.
- ◆ nestled amongst the roots of the Graven-root, a colossal dead tree whose petrified roots form a tangled, maze-like descent full of lingering druidic wards and carnivorous plants.

When the party arrives, the seal is already cracked. The wizard has proffered their blood to the door; the first step in the unsealing ritual. As the party takes in the dark magics, three **carrion crawlers** emerge from the bloody runes: heralds of what is to come. When the last of the wizard's blood is drained (they have 20 max HP, and are currently at 15), it will be too late. But while the wizard yet lives, there is still a chance to reverse the ritual and reseal the door. This might be accomplished by (choose one or more):

- ◆ Completing a group ritual inscribed on the outside of the door, requiring progressive Arcana checks.
- ◆ Activating four sealing stones with four different schools of magic.
- ◆ Painting one of the characters' own blood on the door, permanently sacrificing part of their life's essence to reform the seal.

No matter the method of resealing, interacting with the environment to progress the ritual requires a character to use the Utilize or Magic

action, depending on the nature of the action. Additionally, each time it is the wizard's turn in initiative, so long as they are continuing to release the seal, a wave of dark energy spills out from the door. This drains more of the wizard's vitality and causes the party to hear the stirring heartbeat of whatever monstrosity lurks within: the wizard takes 1d6 necrotic damage, and non-monstrosities in the room take 1d4+1 necrotic damage.

***Suggested Level:** 4-5*

TRIAL OF THE FALLING STAR

Days ago, a comet streaked across the sky and crashed somewhere in the high ranges beyond Mount Egeiro. The mages of the observatory witnessed its descent and believe the fallen fragment to be of immense magical value. As part of the observatory's agreement with the Silver Sage's palace, they've offered the comet's recovery as a trial: retrieve the celestial fragment in exchange for the right to ask Pythiarmai a single question.

Unbeknownst to the observatory, a rival sect, a group of four **cultists** led by a **cultist fanatic**, has already begun the journey. The party may encounter them on the mountain trail, near the crash site, or in a direct confrontation at the crater.

As the characters approach the crash site, the area is warped by the raw energy of the fragment. The area within a 30 foot radius of the fragment may have effects like:

- ◆ Creatures within range shed dim light in a 10-foot radius and can't benefit from being invisible.

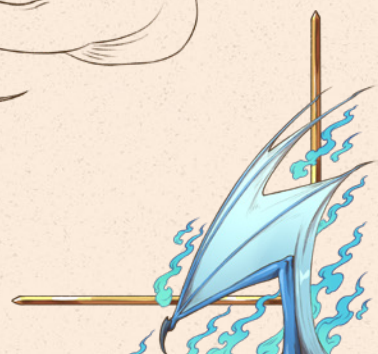
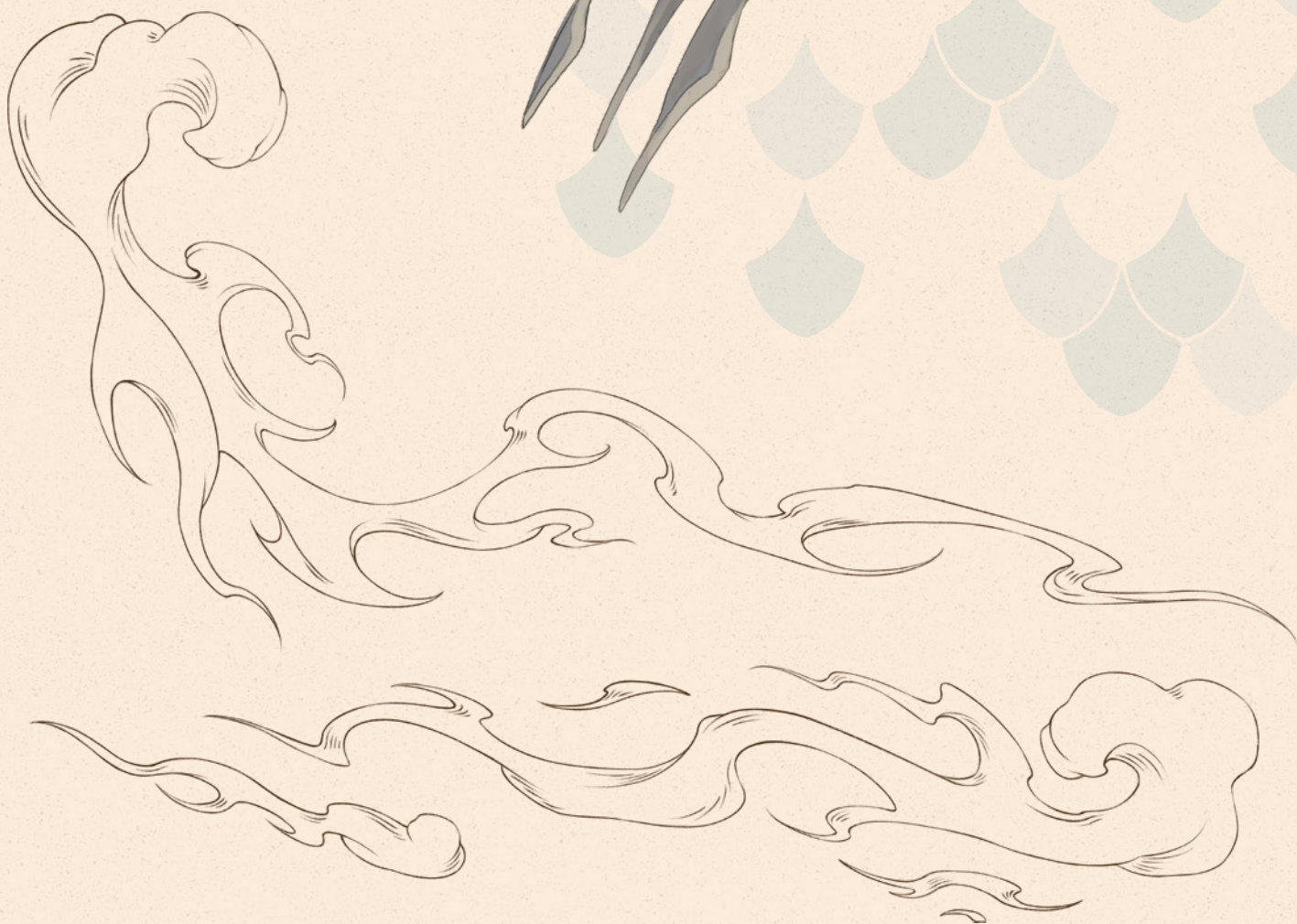




- ◆ Gravitational distortion imposes disadvantage on ranged weapon attacks if either the attacker or the target is within the area
- ◆ Each creature that ends its turn within the area takes 1d4 radiant damage.

Once stored in the special warded crate the characters were provided with (using a Utilize action), the fragment's effects end.

Suggested Level: 3-4





Warden Dragons

IN THIS SECTION YOU'LL FIND STAT BLOCKS AND LORE FOR DIFFERENT WARDEN DRAGONS. WARDEN DRAGONS ARE A POINTY HAT ORIGINAL CATEGORY OF DRAGON BASED ON THE DIFFERENT 5E CLASSES.

Even among the wildly different draconic families, there are bound to be those that break the mold, and warden dragons are exactly that. While most dragons hoard prized magical items, mountains of gold, or spoils from previous battles, warden dragons are defined by their hoards—because their hoards are people.

This focus on amassing quantities of select mortals as part of their hoards makes warden dragons inherently social creatures. Whereas many dragons prefer the peace and quiet of the natural world, or the unending solitude of the ether surrounding the planes, warden dragons make their homes and keep their hoards where people live. Because of their

very nature, warden dragons, especially the most powerful ones, end up naturally playing key roles in the power structures of the societies they inhabit. But the differences between warden dragons and other members of the draconic family don't end there. Warden dragons' power grows as their hoards do.

In their juvenile stages, any warden dragon starts by finding a specific mortal who matches the hoard they want to build. That mortal is soon joined by a small group of other mortals, and as the hoard grows in number, so does the dragon grow in strength. A warden dragon's power is not measured in years lived, like it is for other dragons, but in how many mortals have joined its hoard.



The hoard of a warden dragon is not only its most prized possession, but also the source of their power, and the only way that any warden dragon can ensure its continued existence.

Warden dragons do not lay eggs; instead, they select one of the members of their hoard, one who shows particular promise and aptitude, often referred to as a prince. Once the time is right, the dragon performs a ritual with the goal of transferring their draconic essence into the prince. If it's successful, a new warden dragon is born from the prince: they transform into said dragon, maintaining the essence of the original within them. This way, warden dragons literally birth their successors from their hoards.

So connected are these dragons to their hoards that what kind of people they take under their wing dictates the sort of warden dragon they are. There are many different types of warden dragons, defined not by the color or material of their scales, but by the company they keep.

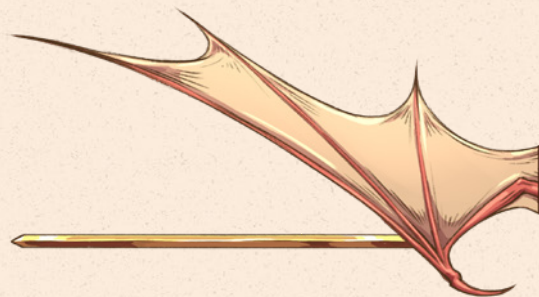
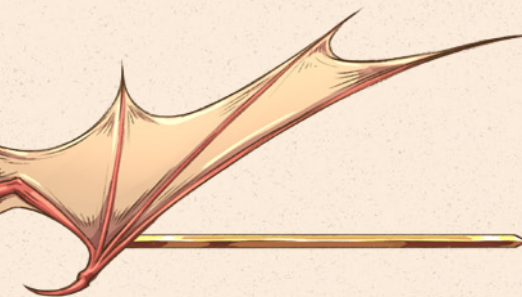
Magus dragons hoard arcane practitioners; elder magus dragons are known to form massive universities where arcane knowledge is exchanged and learned. Knight dragons make armies of their hoards, with a strict hierarchy and military training. Rooker dragons, on the other hand, steal their hoards and form thieves' guilds and pirate crews from their kidnapped victims. A warden dragon's hoard wildly differs from dragon to dragon.

Some scholars of draconology believe that it's this proximity to mortals that gives warden dragons their characteristic appearance.

Warden dragons are diverse in the color and material of their scales; instead they can be recognized by the animal characteristics each takes on in addition to the reptilian appearance that all dragons share.

Despite the massive differences between the types of warden dragons, they all share the commitment to growing their hoard. Some hoards are made out of willing participants, who join the ranks of like-minded individuals under the leadership of an impossibly powerful dragon to grow in power and their area of expertise. Others are forced into a life of servitude to the dragon, both servant and source of power to an unknowable being much more capable than any lone member of the hoard. Which method a warden dragon will choose to grow its hoard, only each individual warden dragon can say.





Archon

Sorcerer Warden Dragon

Out of all warden dragons, archon dragons seek to form the most close-knit communities out of their hoards, where hoard members and dragon share the strongest and most personal bonds—but this does not mean that archon dragons are above evil.

A young archon dragon will seek out hoard-mates among those who have traditionally been rejected by society. Archon dragons specifically look for those who are powerless, destitute, and desperate for community, and give them power of their own. They are magical batteries, and those who join their hoard develop sorcerous powers just from proximity to the archon. Finally having both a community to call their own and access to a power they never had before often makes the members of an archon dragon's hoard incredibly loyal to the hoard, and to the dragon who leads it. This is an incredibly potent combination, and, in the claws of the wrong dragon, a deadly one.

An archon dragon hoard is often called a “syndicate,” although some just refer to it as a family. Because archon dragons deliberately target people ostracized by society, syndicates that grow powerful and large enough often take over the criminal underbellies of cities. Unlike

mundane syndicates, though, the members of the hoard have access not only to the powerful connections that the hoard affords them, but literal sorcerous powers. The member of the hoard who shows the most unwavering loyalty to the syndicate is, in return, given the most sorcerous power. The archon dragon chooses one of these most loyal members as their heir, called their prince; eventually, the prince will receive the archon dragon's very essence and become an archon dragon themselves.

However, the implied threat is obvious. Members of a syndicate hoard know all too well that everything they have acquired is because of the connections and the power that their dragon leader has granted them—and what one hand gives, the other can take away. Those who leave the syndicate or, worse, betray it, find that their sorcerous power was never truly theirs. The dragon can take it away from them just as easily as it was given.

It would be a mistake, however, to assume that all archon dragons create their hoards with evil intent in mind. Many syndicates, even criminal ones, endeavor to give a home to those whom society has shunned for any reason, and they are known to be welcoming



to any who seek to enter their ranks, regardless of creed, appearance, or past mistakes. There are also quite a few documented cases of archon dragons establishing themselves in orphanages and even leper colonies, taking care of their hoardmates and protecting them from an outside world that has failed them when they needed it most. For this reason, archon dragons are also sometimes referred to as “nanny dragons.”





Tactics

- ◆ In line with its identity as a sorcerer, the spell list for the archon dragon was chosen to synergize with its Metamagic options. For example, you can use Twinned Spell with *Scorching Ray*, use Careful Spell with *Fireball*, or use Heightened Spell with *Dominate Person*.
- ◆ The archon dragon's signature damage type is Fire (for its fiery personality!). Because Fire Resistance is one of the more common damage Resistances, we have included Transmuted Spell as a Metamagic option; you can transform the fire-themed spells of the dragon into whichever damage type you prefer.
- ◆ In order to make full use of the archon dragon, it needs to be accompanied by other sorcerous members of its hoard. Prepare a Sorcerer stat block to deploy in combat along with the archon dragon. We suggest keeping the Metamagic options simple for ease of use; for example, Careful Spell, Transmuted Spell, and Heightened Spell are easy Metamagic options that don't require a lot of thought or planning to execute. You can copy the way the archon dragon's stat block uses Metamagic, since there is (at the time of writing) no example of Metamagic use in a monster stat block in the most updated verbiage.
- ◆ The archon dragon can act as a counterpart to the patron dragon. Both are Charisma casters, but while one focuses on replenishing Sorcery Points to use its Metamagic, the other focuses on replenishing spell uses of extremely powerful spells.
- ◆ As an homage to the iconic Sorcerer subclass, the archon dragon's Sorcerous Presence calls for the Wild Magic Surge table. Have it on hand to see what wild twists of fate happen at the table.



ARCHON DRAGON

Huge Dragon (Warden), Any Alignment

AC 19 Initiative +11 (21)

HP 199 (19d12 + 76)

Speed 40 ft., Fly 80 ft.

		MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE
STR	18	+4	+4	DEX	12	+1	+1	CON	18	+4	+9
INT	16	+3	+3	WIS	18	+4	+4	CHA	20	+5	+10

Skills Deception +10, Persuasion +10

Immunities Fire

Senses Blindsight 60 ft., Darkvision 120 ft.;

Passive Perception 14

Languages Common, Draconic

CR 16 (XP 15,000, or 18,000 in lair; PB +5)

TRAITS

Draconic Font. While within 60 feet of the archon dragon, all members of the dragon's hoard have the Sorcery Point cost of their Metamagic reduced by one (to a minimum of one).

Legendary Resistance (3/Day, or 4/Day in Lair). If the archon dragon fails a saving throw, it can choose to succeed instead.

Sorcerous Siphon. When a member of the archon dragon's hoard spends Sorcery Points to perform Metamagic, the dragon immediately regains one expended use of its Metamagic.

Syndicate Tactics. The archon dragon and all members of its hoard cannot have Disadvantage on any saving throw as long as they are within 5 feet of a member of the hoard.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The dragon makes three Rend attacks. It can replace up to two Rend attacks with uses of Spellcasting.

Rend. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +9 to hit, reach 10 ft., one target. *Hit:* 15 (2d10 + 4) Slashing damage plus 4 (1d8) Fire damage.

Archon Breath (Recharge 5–6). *Charisma Saving Throw:* DC 18, each creature in a 15-foot Cone.

Failure: 55 (10d10) Fire damage. *Success:* Half damage. Each creature in the area that is part of the archon dragon's hoard takes no damage and regains three Sorcery Points.

Metamagic. The archon dragon can manipulate its spells using Metamagic. Its number of uses of each Metamagic option vary:

- 2/Day Each: Careful Spell, Transmuted Spell
- 1/Day Each: Heightened Spell, Twinned Spell

Spellcasting. The archon dragon casts one of the following spells, requiring no Material components and using Charisma as the spellcasting ability (spell save DC 18, +10 to hit with spell attacks):

- At Will: *Detect Magic, Fireball, Scorching Ray, Shapechange* (Humanoid form only, no Temporary Hit Points gained from the spell, and no Concentration or Temporary Hit Points required to maintain the spell)
- 2/Day Each: *Blight, Haste, Shatter, Wall of Fire*
- 1/Day Each: *Dominate Person, Sunbeam*

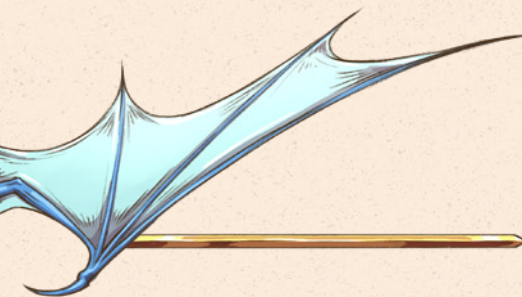
LEGENDARY ACTIONS

Legendary Action Uses: 3 (4 in Lair). Immediately after another creature's turn, the dragon can expend a use to take one of the following actions. The dragon regains all expended uses at the start of each of its turns.

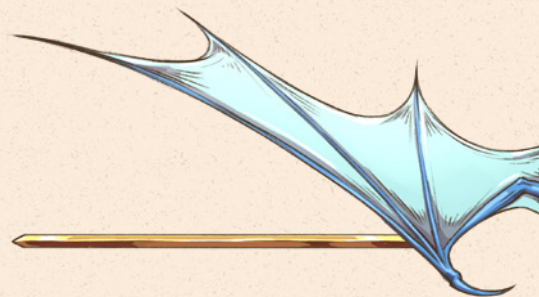
Sorcerous Presence. *Constitution Saving Throw:* DC 18, each creature in a 30-foot-radius Sphere centered on the dragon. *Failure:* 10 (3d6) Fire damage, and the target must roll on the Wild Magic Surge table immediately after casting any leveled spell or cantrip until the end of its next turn.

Archon's Call. The dragon summons a member of its hoard to an unoccupied space within 30 feet of itself (if any are available). The dragon can't take this action again until the start of its next turn.

Pounce. The dragon moves up to half its Speed, and it makes one Rend attack.



Knight



Fighter Warden Dragon

It's often said that knight dragons fluctuate between a state of peace and a state of conflict. During their peaceful state, they practice, learn, and even create new fighting techniques. They teach these techniques to the soldiers that have joined their hoard, as that's what knight dragons hoard: an army.

While other warden dragons welcome as many mortals as possible into their hoards to grow their power, knight dragons are quite discerning. They only accept those who display great martial prowess or the right disposition to one day become a great warrior. It's also during their peaceful states that knight dragons are most open to allowing new members to join the ranks of their hoard, as once a knight dragon decides to enter its conflict state, there will be little time for conscription. A knight dragon's idea of "conflict" is all-out war.

Knight dragons live for battle, and see war as a time to test the techniques they and their hoard practiced during times of peace. This mentality means that knight dragons often find themselves leading the military branches of entire nations, with each and every soldier a member of their hoard.

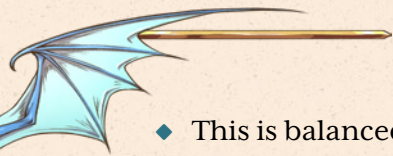
A knight dragon can be an incredible asset for the nations that accept these dragons leading their military, as granting this power to a

dragon means that they have a centuries-old being of immense power concentrating exclusively on the defense of the nation—but there's a catch. Sometimes, after a prolonged conflict, a knight dragon ends up gaining too much influence over the country they serve. When this happens, the importance of the military grows along with the hoard of the dragon. Knight dragons have been known to take control of the country they once served, instituting martial law and beginning an expansionist approach to the management of military affairs.

A knight dragon in a sufficiently powerful position can lead a nation to become an empire, growing its military presence constantly—which also means growing the dragon's own power, since the military is the dragon's hoard in and of itself. The dragon then plunges the nation into a state of perpetual conflict, a constant and neverending war. After all, war itself is the preferred habitat of the knight dragon.

Tactics

- ◆ The knight dragon is the tankiest out of all the dragons present in this folio. It boasts the highest Hit Point total and highest AC; it can also deal the highest amount of damage out of all of them.



- ◆ This is balanced by it being the dragon that both offers and benefits from the least amount of utility. The knight dragon concentrates almost entirely on dealing and taking damage.
- ◆ The combat experience remains dynamic thanks to its Fighting Style trait. Much like the Fighter class that inspires it, the knight dragon has access to different Fighting Styles that change the way it can behave in combat.
- ◆ The Defensive Style allows it to boast the highest AC of all warden dragons, whereas the Duelist Style concentrates on dealing even more damage. The Agile Style gives it access to hit-and-run tactics, allowing it to not provoke Opportunity Attacks and making full use of its upgraded Pounce ability.
- ◆ The knight dragon can and should use its different Fighting Styles to adapt to the turning tides of battle.
- ◆ The knight dragon boasts the shortest spell list out of all warden dragons, but it does get access to a particularly dangerous spell in the form of the Heat Metal Legendary Action. If a Barbarian has been brushing off the knight dragon's Slashing damage, they might have a tougher time if they can no longer hold their axe. Ditto for a Paladin who can no longer wear their armor without taking Fire damage.





- ◆ The knight dragon is much less dependent on its hoardmates than the spellcasting-focused dragons are, and has been designed

to forgo utility in favor of combat prowess, but it can still help its hoard with its Knight Commander trait.

KNIGHT DRAGON

Huge Dragon (Warden), Any Alignment

AC 19 (20 in Defensive Style) **Initiative** +12 (22)
HP 212 (17d12 + 102)
Speed 40 ft., Fly 80 ft.

MOD			SAVE			MOD			SAVE			MOD			SAVE								
STR	25	+7	+12	DEX	12	+1	+1	CON	22	+6	+11	INT	15	+2	+2	WIS	20	+5	+5	CHA	14	+2	+2

Skills Athletics +12, Insight +10

Immunities Bludgeoning, Slashing, and Piercing

Senses Blindsight 120 ft., Darkvision 120 ft.;
passive Perception 15

Languages Common, Draconic

CR 16 (XP 15,000, or 18,000 in lair; PB +5)

TRAITS

Fighting Style. At the start of each of its turns, the dragon chooses one of three Fighting Styles. The effect lasts until the start of its next turn, upon which it chooses again:

- **Agile:** The dragon does not provoke Opportunity Attacks and can move up to its full Speed using its Pounce action.
- **Defensive:** The dragon gains a +1 bonus to its AC.
- **Dueling:** The dragon gains a +1 bonus to attack and damage rolls as long as it targets the same creature for the duration.

Legendary Resistance (3/Day, or 4/Day in Lair). If the dragon fails a saving throw, it can choose to succeed instead.

Knight Commander. All allies of the dragon cannot have Disadvantage on their attack rolls while they are within 30 feet of the dragon.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The dragon makes three Rend attacks.

Rend. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +12 to hit, reach 10 ft., one target. *Hit:* 23 (3d10 + 7) Slashing damage.

Rend (Dueling Style Only). *Melee Weapon Attack:* +13 to hit, reach 10 ft., one target. *Hit:* 24 (3d10 + 8) Slashing damage.

Knight Breath (Recharge 5–6). *Dexterity Saving Throw:* DC 19, each creature in a 90-foot-long, 5-foot-wide Line. *Failure:* 60 (11d10) Slashing damage. *Success:* Half damage.

Spellcasting. The dragon casts one of the following spells, requiring no Material components and using Wisdom as the spellcasting ability (spell save DC 18):

- At Will: *Detect Magic*, *Shapechange* (Humanoid form only, no Temporary Hit Points gained from the spell, and no Concentration or Temporary Hit Points required to maintain the spell)

LEGENDARY ACTIONS

Legendary Action Uses: 3 (4 in Lair). Immediately after another creature's turn, the dragon can expend a use to take one of the following actions. The dragon regains all expended uses at the start of each of its turns.

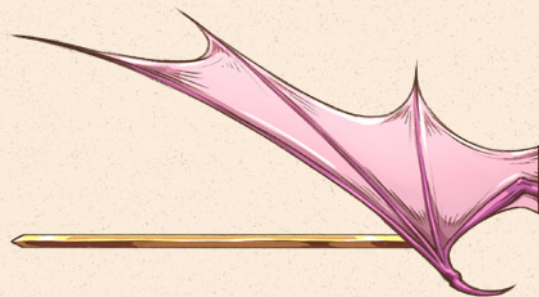
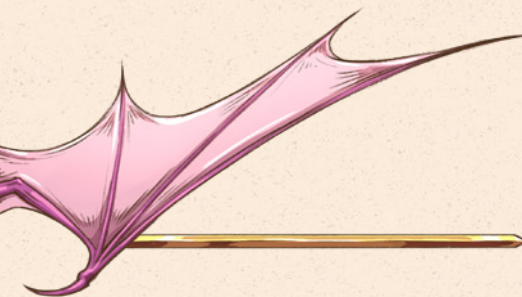
Martial Presence. *Constitution Saving Throw:* DC 18, each creature in a 30-foot-radius Sphere centered on the dragon. *Failure:* 10 (3d6) Slashing damage, and the target gains 1 level of Exhaustion until the end of its next turn. The dragon can't take this action again until the start of its next turn.

Heat Metal. The dragon uses Spellcasting to cast *Heat Metal*. The dragon can't take this action again until the start of its next turn.

Pounce. The dragon moves up to half its Speed and makes one Rend attack.

Pounce (Agile Style Only). The dragon moves up to its full Speed without provoking Opportunity Attacks and makes one Rend attack.





Magus

Wizard Warden Dragon

Magus dragons, like all warden dragons, hoard people, and the people that make up a magus hoard are exclusively arcane practitioners.

Wizards are the most common members of a magus dragon's hoard, but it's not rare to see Lore Bards among their ranks and even the rare City Druid. The only spellcasters never found among their ranks are Warlocks, Sorcerers, and Clerics.

Magus dragons are powerful spellcasters, but their magic is not innate. They feel a deep and seething hatred toward any magic they feel hasn't been acquired through long and careful study. Sorcerers and Warlocks are most often the subjects of their scorn, as magus dragons see them as cheaters, shortcut-takers, or recipients of an unfair advantage through their lineage.

This outlook on magic as something to be rigorously studied and mastered leads magus dragons to form hoards not of just any arcane practitioners, but only of those who are interested in—or even motivated by—the prospect of countless hours of study. This might seem dire to some, but to others, those who would benefit and thrive in the hoard of the magus, this is an incredible opportunity. Magus dragons

study their whole lives, and then pass down their arcane secrets in the same ritual with which they pass along their draconic essence. The secrets that a magus dragon can teach its hoard are innumerable, and often reason enough to join said hoard.

Magus dragons follow warden dragons in their animalesque appearance, taking on more avian traits that make them resemble owls. A mark of their insistence on the study of magic is their wings, which they magically inscribe with spells, using their own bodies as their wizarding spellbooks. They also replace the white down of the owl with their trademark massive beards, which all magus dragons sport regardless of sex. It is said that the traditional idea of a Wizard having a long white beard and writing spells in a grimoire comes from the first Wizards imitating their draconic leaders.

When a magus dragon's hoard has accrued enough members, it is called a Circle; particularly big Circles find themselves becoming veritable universities. Some of the oldest and most renowned institutions of arcane learning are the Circles of magus dragons, with centuries of history in the study of the arcane.



Tactics

- ◆ The Magus Dragon, like the Wizards it's based on, has markedly lower Hit Points and AC than dragons of the same CR. It's meant to be run as a spellcasting version of a dragon, which means it needs additional minions in battle alongside it. Use the members of its hoard for this.
- ◆ To compensate for its low HP and AC, the magus dragon can heal itself and increase its AC. Make use of these abilities as soon as they become available to you through Legendary Actions or Reactions. Its self-healing option can even be triggered by the dragon's allies to help it in a pinch.
- ◆ The magus dragon is an extremely intelligent foe; it will not continue a fight it's likely to lose unless there is no other option.
- ◆ The magus dragon's power doesn't come from its base physical attacks, which are quite weak compared to other dragons of similar CRs, but from its extensive spell list.
- ◆ Because of its reliance on spellcasting, the magus dragon has the ability to recover spell slots through Arcane Recovery and its breath weapon, as well as the ability to update its spell list mid-combat, gaining new uses for these spells.



MAGUS DRAGON

Huge Dragon (Warden), Any Alignment

AC 17 (22 with Shield) **Initiative** +14 (24)

HP 180 (19d12 + 57)

Speed 40 ft., Fly 80 ft.

	MOD	SAVE		MOD	SAVE		MOD	SAVE
STR 12	+1	+1	DEX 18	+4	+4	CON 16	+3	+3
INT 20	+5	+10	WIS 18	+4	+9	CHA 16	+3	+3

Skills Arcana +10, Investigation +10

Immunities Psychic

Senses Blindsight 60 ft., Darkvision 120 ft.;
passive Perception 14

Languages All Standard Languages, Draconic

CR 16 (XP 15,000, or 18,000 in lair; PB +5)

TRAITS

Arcane Recovery (1/Day). Once the magus dragon finishes a Short Rest, it can choose expended uses of spells to recover. It can either recover the use of one 1/Day spell, all uses of two 2/Day spells, or all uses of three 3/Day spells.

Brilliant. The magus dragon can concentrate on two spells at once, but it must make Constitution saving throws to maintain Concentration for each spell it's concentrating on.

Legendary Resistance (3/Day, or 4/Day in Lair). If the magus dragon fails a saving throw, it can choose to succeed instead.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The dragon makes three Rend attacks. It can replace up to two Rend attacks with uses of Spellcasting.

Rend. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +9 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 13 (2d8 + 4) slashing damage.

Magus Breath (Recharge 5–6). *Intelligence Saving Throw:* DC 18, each creature in a 15-foot Cone. *Failure:* 55 (10d10) Psychic damage. *Success:* Half damage. Additionally, if a spellcasting creature fails its saving throw, it loses one spell slot of the lowest level it currently has. The magus dragon regains one use of its 3/Day spells per spell slot lost to the magus dragon's breath.

Spellcasting. The magus dragon casts one of the following spells, requiring no Material components and using Intelligence as the spellcasting ability (spell save DC 18):

- At Will: *Magic Missile* (level 4 version), *Shapechange* (Humanoid form only, no Temporary Hit Points gained from the spell, and no Concentration or Temporary Hit Points required to maintain the spell), *Silence*
- 3/Day Each: *Counterspell*, *Fireball*, *Shield*
- 2/Day Each: *Blink*, *Haste*, *Slow*
- 1/Day Each: *Circle of Death*, *Polymorph*, *Scrying*

LEGENDARY ACTIONS

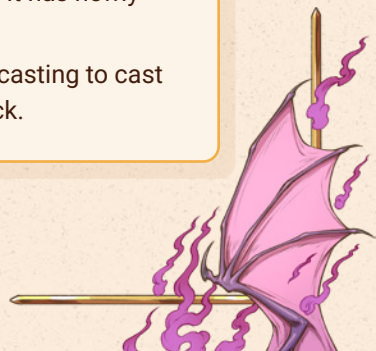
Legendary Action Uses: 3 (4 in Lair). Immediately after another creature's turn, the dragon can expend a use to take one of the following actions. The dragon regains all expended uses at the start of each of its turns.

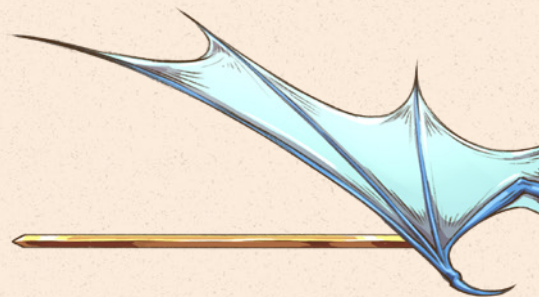
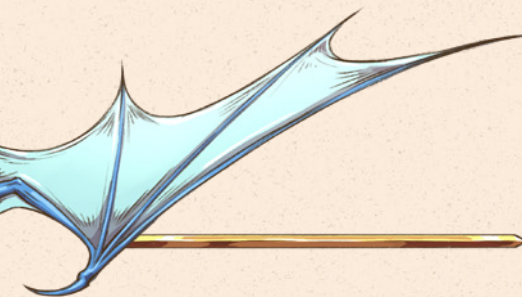
Arcane Presence. *Constitution Saving Throw:* DC 10, each creature of the magus dragon's choice in a 30-foot-radius Sphere centered on the dragon. *Failure:* The target loses Concentration on any spell it was concentrating on.

Arcane Siphon. When a creature within 120 feet of the magus dragon that it can see casts a leveled spell, the dragon may expend a use of its Legendary Actions to force the creature to make an Intelligence saving throw (DC 18). *Failure:* The dragon rolls a Hit Die and gains a number of Hit Points equal to the result of the roll. The dragon can't take this action again until the start of its next turn.

Expedited Learning. When a creature within 120 feet of the dragon that it can see casts a spell of 3rd level or lower, the dragon may expend a use of its Legendary Actions to replace any of its 1/Day spells with the one it just learned. The dragon has all uses of the new spell, regardless of how many uses it had left of the spell it replaces. The dragon can't take this action again until it has cast the spell it has newly committed to memory.

Misty Pounce. The dragon uses Spellcasting to cast *Misty Step* and makes one Rend attack.





Patron

Warlock Warden Dragon

A patron dragon builds its hoard through contracts. Just like archon dragons, the warden dragons associated with sorcery, seek out societal outcasts and the marginalized to offer them a sense of community, patron dragons specifically seek out the hopeless—those who desperately need power and yet find themselves powerless. It's said they can literally smell desperation; that's when they strike.

The dragons offer a deal that will make all their problems go away, power that the potential hoardmate could only dream of. In exchange, they must only belong to the dragon's hoard. If desperation doesn't push the dragon's target to join, their thirst for power often does. Soon enough, the patron dragon finds itself with its own hoard, and its power grows.

But a patron dragon must be careful, as their source of power is not infinite. While archon dragons radiate power to those around them indiscriminately, patron dragons can choose exactly how much power to grant, to what individual, and when to take it away—but whenever they do, some of the dragon's own power leaves their body and goes to their Warlocks. They must walk the line between not giving enough of their power, thus risking the loss of their hoard's loyalty, and giving too much

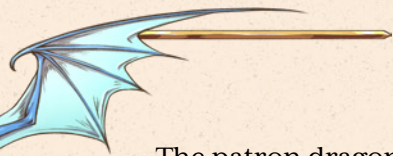
power to their Warlocks, becoming powerless to defend themselves against outside threats.

Some patron dragons navigate this by fostering a specific feeling among their hoard: complete and utter devotion. This is the reason why a patron dragon's hoard is often referred to as a cult. It is not uncommon for the members of a hoard of a patron dragon to believe they worship not a dragon, but a god. Members of these cult-like hoards understand that the only reason they have their power to begin with is the contract they agreed to, and because their patron dragon allows it.

Those who show the greatest devotion to their patron are in turn granted more power, strengthening the hoard's motivation to stand with their patron. The patron dragon then chooses a prince. The prince slowly receives more and more power from their deal with the patron dragon, until more of the dragon's power lives within the prince than within the dragon. When this happens, the patron dragon must be extremely careful, as they are at their weakest at that moment. They must quickly perform the ritual and pass on their draconic essence to their chosen prince.

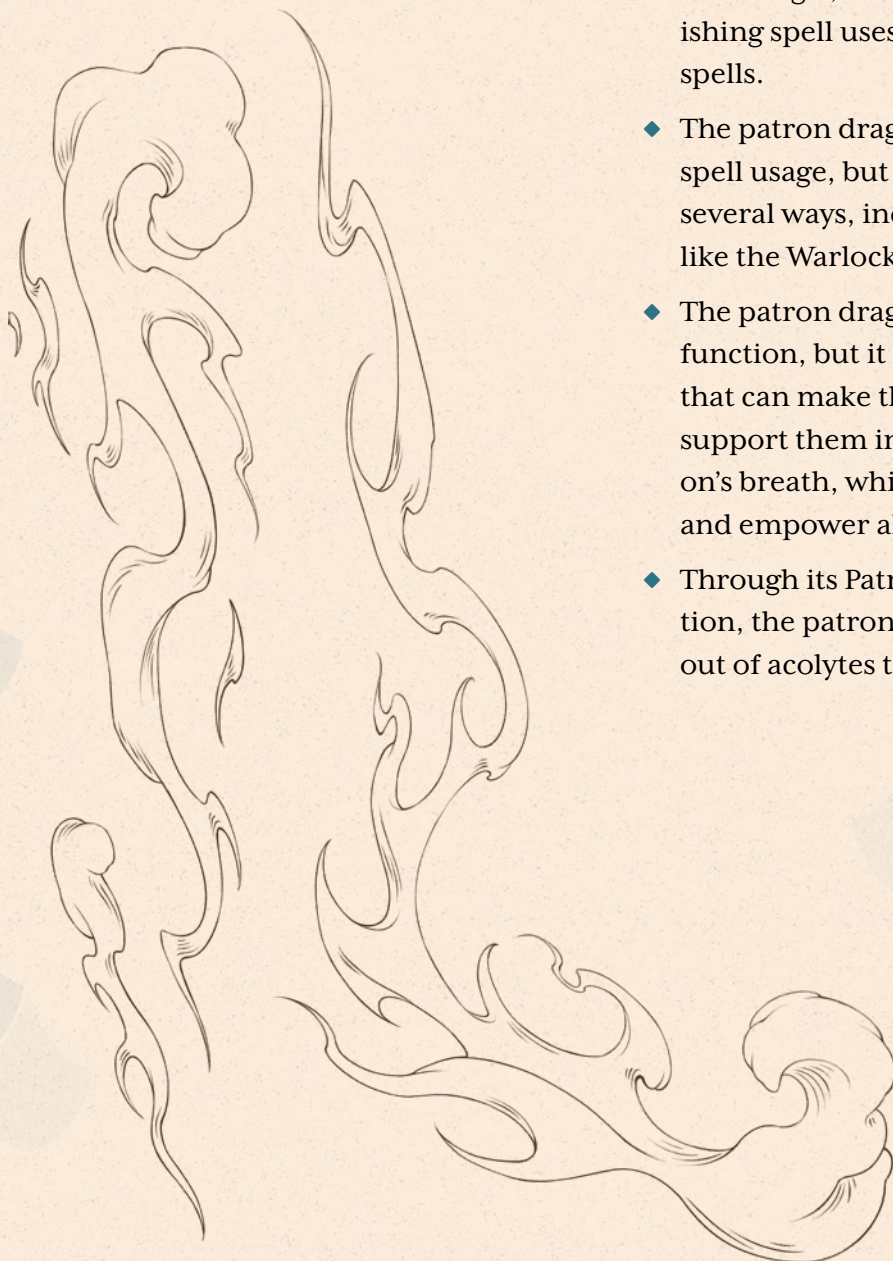
It is, however, just as likely for a patron dragon to decide that the best course of action is to be transparent with their hoardmates as to how much power they will grant, and for what reason. Proficient in legalese after countless years of drafting contracts, there are many patron dragons who find themselves leaders of guilds: adventuring guilds, with a hoard of highly trained Warlock adventurers.





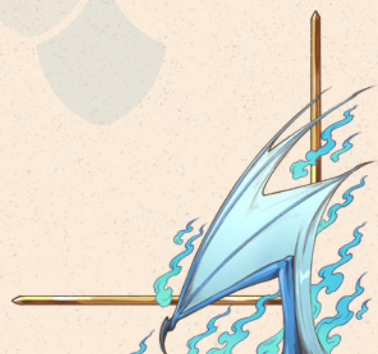
The patron dragon grants their hoardmates more or less power as a reward for more or less dangerous jobs. Some of these adventuring guilds led by patron dragons become world-renowned for their efficiency, becoming pillars of their communities... just as long as these communities pay diligently and read the fine print.

How a warlock dragon decides to run its hoard, whether through cultish devotion or the cold fairness of contracts, is for the patron dragon to decide.



Tactics

- ◆ In line with its identity as a Warlock patron, the patron dragon makes full use of those it has made a pact with in combat. In order to use the patron dragon, prepare a stat block for its Warlocks to deploy along with the dragon.
- ◆ The patron dragon can act as a counterpart to the archon dragon. Both are Charisma casters, but while one focuses on replenishing Sorcery Points to use its Metamagic, the other focuses on replenishing spell uses of extremely powerful spells.
- ◆ The patron dragon has extremely limited spell usage, but it can regain spell uses in several ways, including on a Short Rest, like the Warlock class.
- ◆ The patron dragon needs its acolytes to function, but it also boasts several abilities that can make these acolytes stronger or support them in battle, including its dragon's breath, which can damage enemies and empower allies.
- ◆ Through its Patron's Call Legendary Action, the patron dragon should not run out of acolytes to use in battle.





PATRON DRAGON

Huge Dragon (Warden), Any Alignment

AC 18 **Initiative** +14 (24)

HP 199 (19d12 + 76)

Speed 40 ft., Fly 80 ft., Swim 40 ft.

	MOD	SAVE		MOD	SAVE		MOD	SAVE
STR 12	+1	+1	DEX 18	+4	+4	CON 18	+4	+4
INT 16	+3	+3	WIS 18	+4	+9	CHA 20	+5	+10

Skills Deception +10, Intimidation +10

Immunities Psychic

Senses Blindsight 60 ft., Darkvision 120 ft.;

Passive Perception 16

Languages Draconic, Common; telepathy 120 ft.

CR 16 (XP 15,000, or 18,000 in lair; PB +5)

TRAITS

Amphibious. The dragon can breathe air and water.

Draconic Recovery (1/Day). The patron dragon regains all uses of its spells when it finishes a Short or Long Rest.

Legendary Resistance (3/Day, or 4/Day in Lair). If the patron dragon fails a saving throw, it can choose to succeed instead.

Patron's Toll. When a member of the patron dragon's hoard that the dragon can see expends a spell slot, the patron dragon regains one expended use of one of its spells.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The dragon makes four Eldritch Blast attacks. It can replace up to two Eldritch Blast attacks with uses of Spellcasting.

Eldritch Blast. *Ranged Spell Attack:* +10 to hit, reach 300 ft., one target. Hit: 10 (1d10+5) Force damage. On a hit, the patron dragon can choose to move the target in a straight line 10 feet. closer to or away from itself

or to reduce the creature's Speed by 10 feet until the end of the dragon's next turn.

Patron Breath (Recharge 5–6). *Charisma Saving Throw:* DC 18, each creature in a 15-foot Cone. *Failure:* 55 (10d10) Force damage. *Success:* Half damage. Each creature in the area that is part of the patron dragon's hoard takes no damage and regains one use of a spell.

Spellcasting. The patron dragon casts one of the following spells, requiring no Material components and using Charisma as the spellcasting ability (spell save DC 18, +10 to hit with spell attacks):

- *At Will:* *Charm Person*, *Ray of Enfeeblement*, *Sending*, *Shapechange* (Humanoid form only, no Temporary Hit Points gained from the spell, and no Concentration or Temporary Hit Points required to maintain the spell)
- *1/Day Each:* *Blight*, *Circle of Death*, *Eyebite*, *Mass Suggestion*, *Vampiric Touch*

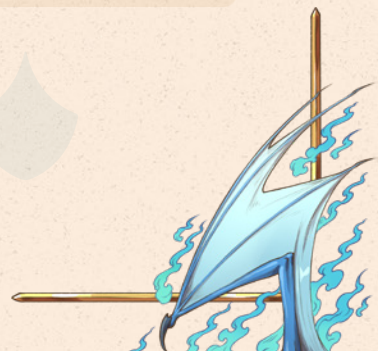
LEGENDARY ACTIONS

Legendary Action Uses: 3 (4 in Lair). Immediately after another creature's turn, the dragon can expend a use to take one of the following actions. The dragon regains all expended uses at the start of each of its turns.

Eldritch Presence. The dragon uses Spellcasting to cast *Hallucinatory Terrain*. The dragon can't take this action again until the start of its next turn.

Patron's Call. The dragon summons a creature it has made a pact with to an unoccupied space within 30 feet of itself (if any are available). The dragon can't take this action again until the start of its next turn.

Pounce. The dragon moves up to half its Speed, and it makes one Eldritch Blast attack.



Rooker

Rogue Warden Dragon

While other warden dragons are seen as pillars of their respective communities and welcomed in the settlements of mortals, rooker dragons are seldom afforded the same kindness, because rooker dragons make hoards of stolen people.

These serpentine draconic thieves gain power from amassing hoards of people who they take from their place of origin. One cannot simply join the ranks of a rooker dragon's hoard. A volunteer would never be counted as part of the hoard, because they weren't stolen away; thievery itself is what makes someone into a hoardmate.





Severed from all familial and communal ties, the hoardmates in a rooker dragon's hoard have few choices as to what to do, and most adapt and survive. This is how some legendary thieves' guilds were formed, as the members of a hoard find themselves obligated to turn to a life of crime. The dragon that lords over them teaches them their uncanny abilities to remain hidden and strike from the darkness, turning them into the best thieves, assassins, and other unsavory warriors they could ever become.

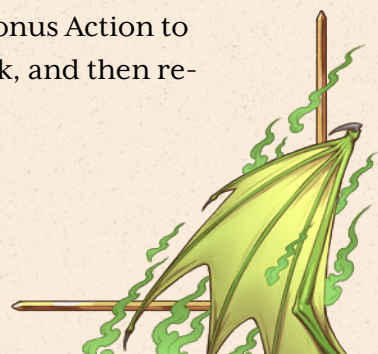
This puts hoardmates on a high-speed path to form a tight-knit found family. Away from anyone they have ever known, forced into a life of crime at the fringes of society, and with no one else to turn to, they turn toward other hoardmates and toward the rooker dragon themselves. Some hoardmates go as far as to steal away other mortals to join the hoard as extensions of the dragon themselves, strengthening not only the guild's ranks, but the dragon.

One might assume that this makes rooker dragons exclusively wretched, evil kidnappers, but this is, perhaps surprisingly, not true for all rooker dragons. The only requisite for a mortal to join the hoard of a rooker dragon is that they must be taken away, but there are people who wish to be taken away from their current situation. Outcasts who have never been allowed to even attempt to fit into their communities, hoardmates of other warden dragons, who were forced to join that hoard against their will and now cannot leave: these are common targets for rooker dragons with a straighter moral compass to make part of their hoard. Nobles forced into arranged marriages to people they despise are surprisingly common in rooker hoards; many of the fairy tales in which a princess is kidnapped by a dragon

take their inspiration from actual incidents involving rooker dragons. There are stories of ragtag pirate crews, spy dens, and thieves' guilds all led by rooker dragons who stole away the members of their hoard to a better life, and where the feeling of found family is not born out of survival, but out of genuine companionship.

Tactics

- ◆ The rooker dragon is the most agile of the warden dragons: it boasts the highest Speed on land, the highest Dexterity, an additional mobility option in its Bonus Actions, and two mobility-focused spells—and, true to its roguish inspiration, it can perform a variety of actions that would normally take a full action as a Bonus Action.
- ◆ The rooker dragon uses its humanoid form to stealthily approach its enemies, then transforms into a dragon for a surprise attack.
- ◆ The rooker dragon has a deadly combat loop designed into its stat block. It begins with a Rooker Breath attack, which not only deals damage but also magically obscures a large portion of the battlefield. It then goes inside the darkness and uses its Blindsight to find its enemies, and uses its Rend attack (now empowered, as the dragon has Advantage as an unseen enemy) to bring its foes down.
- ◆ If its magical darkness gambit is somehow foiled, the rooker dragon will rely on its ability to Disengage as a Bonus Action to go into melee range, attack, and then retreat using its high Speed.





- ◆ The rooker dragon is much less dependent on its hoardmates than the spellcasting-focused dragons are, but it can make good use of them to empower its

Rend attack, and support them in battle in turn by allowing them to take advantage of its magical darkness.

ROOKER DRAGON

Huge Dragon (Warden), Any Alignment

AC 19 **Initiative** +16 (26)

HP 199 (19d12 + 76)

Speed 50 ft., fly 80 ft

		MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE
STR	12	+1	+1	DEX	23	+6	+11	CON	20	+5	+5
INT	20	+5	+5	WIS	16	+3	+3	CHA	18	+4	+9

Skills Sleight of Hand +11, Stealth +11

Immunities Poison

Senses Blindsight 120 ft., Darkvision 120 ft.;
Passive Perception 14

Languages Common, Draconic

CR 16 (XP 15,000, or 18,000 in lair; PB +5)

TRAITS

Legendary Resistance (3/Day, or 4/Day in Lair). If the rooker dragon fails a saving throw, it can choose to succeed instead.

Rooker's Boon. All allies of the dragon have 60 feet of Blindsight while they are within 30 feet of the dragon.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The dragon makes three Rend attacks. It can replace one attack with a use of Spellcasting to cast Vampiric Touch.

Rend. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +11 to hit, reach 10 ft., one target. Hit: 13 (2d6 + 6) Slashing damage. If the dragon has Advantage or one of its allies is engaged in combat with the target, it deals an additional 23 (5d6 + 6) Slashing damage.

Rooker Breath (Recharge 5–6). *Dexterity Saving Throw:* DC 18, each creature in a 15-foot Cone. *Failure:* 55 (10d10) Poison damage. *Success:* Half damage. The area of the Cone is affected by the *Darkness* spell until

the dragon uses this action again.

Spellcasting. The dragon casts one of the following spells, requiring no Material components and using Intelligence as the spellcasting ability (spell save DC 18):

- At Will: *Detect Magic*, *Shapechange* (Humanoid form only, no Temporary Hit Points gained from the spell, and no Concentration or Temporary Hit Points required to maintain the spell), *Silence*, *Vampiric Touch*
- 1/Day Each: *Gaseous Form*, *Longstrider*

BONUS ACTIONS

Cunning Action: The dragon takes the Dash, Disengage, or Hide action.

LEGENDARY ACTIONS

Legendary Action Uses: 3 (4 in Lair). Immediately after another creature's turn, the dragon can expend a use to take one of the following actions. The dragon regains all expended uses at the start of each of its turns.

Roguish Presence. *Constitution Saving Throw:* DC 18, each creature in a 30-foot-radius Sphere centered on the dragon. *Failure:* 10 (3d6) Poison damage, and all creatures Friendly to the rooker dragon have Advantage on attack rolls against targets that failed the saving throw. The dragon can't take this action again until the start of its next turn.

Draconic Fangs. The dragon uses Spellcasting to cast *Vampiric Touch*. The dragon can't take this action again until the start of its next turn.

Pounce. The dragon moves up to half its Speed without provoking Opportunity Attacks, and it makes one Rend attack.





CREATIVE COMMONS

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